Golden Hot Dog Pillows

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

Hot dog puffs are pure childhood nostalgia for me, and these little pillows are my way of dressing them up.

Makes 12 pillows · Prep 20 min · Cook 25 min

INGREDIENTS

- 12 ready-cut puff pastry squares, approximately 10 cm each, preferably all-butter
- 6 good-quality hot dogs, halved crosswise
- 2 tbsp Dijon mustard, or to taste
- 150 g grated cheese: a blend of cheddar, mozzarella and Emmental
- 1 egg, beaten, for brushing, optional

METHOD

1. Preheat the oven to 200°C conventional / 180°C fan, or follow the temperature recommended on your pastry packaging. Line a baking tray with baking paper.
2. Lay the puff pastry squares on your work surface, keeping them chilled until you are ready to assemble.
3. Spread a thin layer of Dijon mustard over the centre of each square, leaving the edges clean.
4. Add a little of the cheese blend, then place a piece of hot dog in the centre.
5. For the pillow shape, make short cuts inward from the edges of the pastry, leaving the centre beneath the filling intact. Fold the pastry sections towards the centre, bringing the corners together and pinching firmly to secure. Leave small openings so the filling peeks through.
6. Arrange on the prepared tray, leaving space between each pillow. If using the egg wash, brush it lightly over the exposed pastry.
7. Bake for 20–25 minutes, or until the pastry is well risen, golden and cooked through underneath.
8. Allow to rest for a few minutes before serving, while the cheese is still warm and melted.

Tip

Choose good puff pastry. A buttery, well-made pâte feuilletée is what gives these pillows their delicate layers and golden crunch.